Colour Contrast

Inclusion Toolkit

What is it for?

Websites, social media images, and out-of-home advertising should have a good colour contrast between text and background colour. That includes links, icons, buttons and any other information.

It's useful for people with vision impairments, colour vision deficiency, cataracts, elderly people, and people in different lighting situations (for example, sun glare on a phone screen).

The general rule is that text and images of text must have a contrast ratio of at least 4.5:1. Large text (18pt / 24px, or 14pt / 18.66px if bold) can have a contrast ratio of 3:1.

How to support it

Choose colours with sufficient contrast. There are lots of colour contrast checkers online, including Colour Contrast checker (colourcontrast.cc), WebAIM's contrast checker, Coolors contrast checker.

Enter your background colour and foreground colour. You want to make sure that it gives you a contrast ratio that is 4.5:1 or higher (so 6:1 is good, 2:1 is bad).

Useful Links

Colour contrast - Why does it matter?

Accessible use of colour

WCAG 2.1 - Contrast (minimum)